

YDZ ENGLISH

TERM 2

WEEK 12

SIMPLE PAST VS. PRESENT PERFECT

What's the difference? Present Perfect and Past Simple

Present Perfect Simple	Past Simple
Unfinished actions that started in the past and continue to the present: I 've known Julie for ten years (and I still know her).	Finished actions: I knew Julie for ten years (but then she moved away and we lost touch).
A finished action in someone's life (when the person is still alive: life experience): My brother has been to Mexico three times.	A finished action in someone's life (when the person is dead): My great-grandmother went to Mexico three times.
A finished action with a result in the present: I 've lost my keys! (The result is that I can't get into my house now).	A finished action with no result in the present: I lost my keys yesterday. It was terrible! (Now there is no result. I got new keys yesterday).
With an unfinished time word (this week, this month, today): I 've seen John this week.	With a finished time word (last week, last month, yesterday): I saw John last week.

1. We use the past simple for past events or actions which have no connection to the present.
2. We use the present perfect for actions which started in the past and are still happening now **OR** for finished actions which have a connection to the present.
3. We **CAN'T** use the present perfect with a finished time word:

NOT: I've been to the museum yesterday.

EXERCISES

A. Choose the past simple or the present perfect:

1. Last night I _____ (lose) my keys – I had to call my flatmate to let me in.
2. I _____ (lose) my keys – can you help me look for them?
3. I _____ (visit) Paris three times.
4. Last year I _____ (visit) Paris.
5. I _____ (know) my great grandmother for a few years - she died when I was eight.
6. I _____ (know) Julie for three years – we still meet once a month.
7. I _____ (play) hockey since I was a child – I'm pretty good!
8. She _____ (play) hockey at school, but she _____ (not / like) it.
9. Sorry, I _____ (miss) the bus, so I'm going to be late.
10. I _____ (miss) the bus, and then I _____ (miss) the aeroplane as well!
11. Last month I _____ (go) to Scotland.
12. I'm sorry, John isn't here now. He _____ (go) to the shops.
13. We _____ (finish) this room last week.

14. I _____ (finish) my exams finally – I'm so happy!
15. Yesterday, I _____ (see) all my friends. It was great.
16. I _____ (see) Julie three times this week!
17. She _____ (live) in London since 1994.
18. She _____ (live) in London when she was a child.
19. I _____ (drink) three cups of coffee this morning.
20. I _____ (drink) seven cups of coffee yesterday.
21. I _____ (never / go) to Vienna.
22. My great grandfather _____ (have) five sisters.
23. He _____ (live) in Manila for a year when he was a student.
24. Oh no! I _____ (lose) my wallet!
25. _____ (you / see) Julie today?
26. At the weekend, they _____ (play) football, then they _____ (go) to a restaurant.
27. I _____ (read) six books this week.
28. Amy _____ (live) in Portugal when she was young.
29. She _____ (visit) her grandmother last month.
30. The Vandals _____ (invade) Rome in the year 455.
31. She _____ (live) in seven different countries, so she knows a lot about different cultures.
32. I _____ (go) to the cinema last night.
33. Ow! I _____ (cut) my finger!
34. _____ (you / see) 'The King's Speech'?
35. John _____ (never / understand) the present perfect.

B. Choose one of the tenses in each pair to complete the conversation.

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|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| 1. Have you seen-Did you see | 2. didn't- haven't |
| 3. have talked-talked | 4. didn't see-haven't seen |
| 5. did he travel-has he travelled | 6. flew-has flown |
| 7. was in- have been to | 8. have spent-spent |
| 9. was never in- have never been to | 10. has Greg come- did Greg come |
| 11. called- have called | 12. was-has been |

A: (1)..... Greg lately?

B: No, I (2)..... I (3)..... to him at the airport two weeks ago. But I (4)..... him since then.

A: Where (5).....?

B: He (6)..... to Greece for a holiday.

A: I (7)..... Greece three times. I love Greece.

B: Really? My wife and I (8)..... a week in Turkey last year, but I (9)..... Greece. By the way, (10)..... back yet?

A: I don't know. I (11)..... him yesterday, but there (12)..... no reply.